

01-28-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9icZjmY5kLk
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Muncie Community Schools - Board of School Trustees Meeting Report

Meeting Date: January 28, 2025 (implied by context and timeline of grants/items)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or separate committee session was held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by presiding officer President Williams [00:05:55](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. [Pratt/name in transcript unclear], Far Griffin, Dr. Wurn, Mr. Urban, Mr. W [Drum]. (Note: Presiding officer noted "everyone present" during roll call [00:07:06](#)).
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - A moment of silence was observed [00:05:57](#).
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was led by children from South View Elementary accompanied by Dr. Casey [00:06:12](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text provided.)*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:07:13](#) **Spotlight & Recognition: Steve Spradlin - CEDAL Certification**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Leadership team, joined by Bill Stein and Darling Kennedy from the Indiana CTO (Chief Technology Officer) Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board recognized Steve Spradlin for earning his international CEDAL certification after completing a mentorship program and rigorous exam, placing Muncie Community Schools in the top five in the nation for certified educational technology leaders.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Recognition only; no formal vote required.
- [00:12:01](#) **Spotlight Presentation: South View Elementary <U+2013> "The Power of Interventions"**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Casey Smithman (Principal), Sean Davis (Assistant Principal), along with teachers, volunteers, and student/parent speakers (Amaya Denise Johnson, Tyler Benson, Briana Thompson, Autumn, and Heather Gamble).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Detailed presentation on academic interventions, data-driven meetings, literacy gains (I-READ pass rates rising from 38% to projected 80%+), improved student attendance (rising above 94%), and declining disciplinary suspensions. The school also highlighted community partnerships (Ball State, Ivy Tech, local churches, real Black Excellence) and the impact of the Indiana Literacy Cadre and learning walks.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Presentation and community celebration; no formal vote required.
- [00:48:00](#) **Early Literacy & Pre-K Expansion Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** District administration / Curriculum team (accompanied by Laura Swankia / Swanka).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Highlighted district-wide elementary growth, the implementation of CCLA and Hegerty's "Bridge to Writing," and the expansion of Pre-K enrollment from 50 to 246 students. Noted successful utilization of state "On My Way Pre-K" and CCDF vouchers.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Informational report; no formal vote required.
- [01:08:49](#) **Consent Agenda & New Hires**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** District Administration / Board.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Introduction of new staff hires including Marina Bara (ENL Teacher, Muncie Central), Emma Jacobs (6th Grade Math, Southside Middle), Andrea Mann (Longfellow Elementary), and Brandon Hayes (Interim Dean of Students, Southside Middle).
- **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:12:34](#).
- **[01:12:43](#) Workers' Compensation and Cyber Insurance Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Drum / USI Insurance Consultants.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of annual insurance renewals. Workers' comp is moving to ipep and cyber insurance is moving to Coalition (providing higher coverage with only a modest \$535 overall premium increase). The board discussed cyber security testing and ransomware protections.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:15:37](#).
- **[01:15:42](#) High School Redesign, Curriculum Handbook, & Honor Graduate Policy**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** District Administration / Curriculum Team.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of the 140+ page high school curriculum handbook update reflecting the state's new Indiana diploma requirements (moving to 42 credits, eliminating the general diploma, adding personal finance, and establishing 6 career/college seals). The handbook also codifies the Freshman Academy/Seminar and the transition away from valedictorian/salutatorian to a collegiate-style latin honors graduation recognition model (Cum Laude, Magna Cum Laude, Summa Cum Laude) starting with the class containing current juniors.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:42:03](#).
- **[01:42:16](#) Early Literacy Grant Allocation (2025)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Board consideration of the state IDOE Early Literacy Grant allocation for K-3 teachers based on I-READ scores. Muncie received \$36,200.99 for the district. Highly effective teachers receive a 25% higher stipend than effective teachers, with payroll distribution mandated by March 28th.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:44:31](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general public comment forum occurred during this meeting; community input was integrated directly into the South View Elementary spotlight presentation via parent and volunteer testimonials).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Acknowledgment of extreme winter weather and appreciation for transportation and parent flexibility.
 - Southside Middle School robotics team qualifying a second robot for the state championship in March.
 - Black History Month kick-off event scheduled for Saturday at Minnetrista (including the MLK essay contest awards).
 - Winter sports seasons concluding with girls' basketball sectionals approaching.
 - Upcoming 8th Grade Parent Night scheduled for February 13th regarding high school diploma pathways.
 - **Adjournment:** Official adjournment by voice vote [01:44:42](#).
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